



CONTROLLED ENTERPRISE DOCUMENT

TBT-01.16 | Wind Safety Crane Limits

MH Construction, INC Enterprise Management System

Document family: TOOLBOX TALK LIBRARY

Document title: TBT-01.16 | Wind Safety Crane Limits

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Use only after required functional, technical, field-usability, and approval gates are complete.

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MH Construction, INC

TOOLBOX TALK: TBT-01.16

TOPIC: Wind Safety, Crane Limits & Pasco Weather Protocols

TRACK: Track 4 Universal (Mandatory for Spring & Fall Operations)

1. DIRECTIVE (Policy Standard)

MH Construction, INC strictly enforces wind limits across all operations. No crane lift, elevated steel erection, or high-profile material handling shall occur when sustained winds exceed 20 MPH or gusts exceed 30 MPH, or lower if dictated by the equipment manufacturer's specifications. Pasco seasonal wind events require proactive site securing.

2. GENERAL ORDER (Execution Standard)

The Columbia Basin experiences severe, sudden wind events, primarily in Spring (March-May) and Fall (September-November). The Superintendent or Foreman is the final authority on halting work due to wind. All loose materials must be strapped, banded, or weighted at the end of every shift. When wind speeds approach limits, all elevated work (roofing, scaffolding, structural steel) must be assessed continuously.

3. KEY HAZARDS & MITIGATION (The "What If")

- SCENARIO: Crane Operations in Gusting Winds

The Hazard: A sudden gust catches a large surface area load (e.g., PEMB wall panel, plywood bundle), causing it to swing uncontrollably or exceed the crane's load chart limits.

The Mitigation: The Operator and Rigger must calculate the "sail area" of the load. Taglines are mandatory on ALL lifts. If the load cannot be controlled by two taglines, the lift is scrubbed. Do not attempt to muscle a swinging load.

- SCENARIO: Roofing, Scaffolding, and Elevated Steel

The Hazard: Wind speeds at 40 feet are significantly higher than at ground level. Workers carrying sheet metal, decking, or insulation boards act as sails, leading to loss of balance and falls.

The Mitigation: WISHA requires fall protection at 4 feet. Ensure 100% tie-off. If carrying materials becomes unstable, lower the materials and descend. Do not stack loose decking or insulation on the roof without immediate mechanical fastening or heavy weighting.

- SCENARIO: Road Work, Trenching, and Civil Operations

The Hazard: High winds generate massive dust clouds (Silica hazard) and blow over traffic control devices, exposing crews to live traffic.

The Mitigation: Water trucks must run continuously. If dust cannot be controlled, work stops. All traffic cones and barricades must be sandbagged. High-visibility Class 3 apparel is mandatory when visibility drops.

- SCENARIO: Fleet Operations and Material Transport

The Hazard: Driving flatbeds or towing enclosed trailers across the I-182 bridge or exposed highways during a wind advisory.

The Mitigation: Double-check all DOT chains and binders before departure. If hauling a light, high-profile trailer empty, reduce speed by 15 MPH or delay transport until the advisory lifts.

4. FIELD INSTRUCTION (Immediate Action)

Look around the site right now. Identify every stack of plywood, foam insulation, and loose sheet metal. Assign crews to band, strap, or weight them down before the end of the shift. Check the weather app for afternoon wind gusts.

5. ATTENDANCE LOG

Foreman: Scan the QR code below to log attendance digitally via MISH-F-10.1 on the MH Dashboard, or use the physical sign-in sheet in the site binder.

[INSERT QR CODE HERE - LINK TO MISH-F-10.1]